Complete Setup Guide

Every column · every transaction type · ticker format. For the 9 tabs, see your Template Link PDF.

TRANSACTION LOG: ALL COLUMNS

Col	Field	Notes
A	Date	Format yyyy-mm-dd. The transaction date.
B	Year	Calculated from column A. Do not edit.
C	Account	Dropdown: TFSA or RRSP. Required on every row.
D	Type	Dropdown: Buy · Sell · Contribution · Withdrawal · Dividend · DRIP · Transfer In · Transfer Out
E	Ticker	Canadian: TSE: prefix required (TSE:RY). US: ticker only, no prefix (KO, AAPL).
F	Description	Optional stock name. Helps the portfolio tabs show names.
G	Currency	CAD or USD. USD rows convert to CAD automatically.
H	Shares	Number of shares. Leave blank for contributions, withdrawals and dividends.
I	Price/Share	Price per share in the original currency.
J	Fees	Brokerage fees, often $0 at Wealthsimple or Questrade.
K	Amount	Dollar amount for contributions, withdrawals and dividends. Leave blank for Buy and Sell.
L	FX Rate	Fetches the live USD/CAD rate for USD rows. Type it in yourself for older trades.
M	Amt CAD	LOCKED: (H × I + J) or K, converted to CAD using L. Never edit.

TRANSACTION TYPES

Type	Required fields	Notes
Contribution	Date, Account, Type, Amount (K)	No ticker. Counts against your annual room on the Main Dashboard.
Withdrawal	Date, Account, Type, Amount (K)	TFSA withdrawals are added back to your room on January 1 of the next year. RRSP withdrawals are taxable income and the room is not restored.
Buy	Date, Account, Type, Ticker, Shares, Price	Canadian: TSE: prefix. US: ticker only (KO, not NASDAQ:KO).
Sell	Date, Account, Type, Ticker, Shares, Price	ACB recalculates automatically. Gains in a TFSA are tax-free; in an RRSP they are tax-deferred.

Type	Required fields	Notes
Dividend	Date, Account, Type, Ticker (optional), Amount	Cash dividend. Feeds the Dividend Tracker.
DRIP	Date, Account, Type, Ticker, Shares, Price	Reinvested dividend. Adds shares and increases your ACB.
Transfer In	Date, Account, Type, Ticker, Shares	Holdings moved in from another brokerage.
Transfer Out	Date, Account, Type, Ticker, Shares	Holdings moved out to another brokerage.

GOOGLEFINANCE TICKER FORMAT: IMPORTANT

US stocks and ETFs do NOT need an exchange prefix. Adding the wrong one (for example NASDAQ:KO, when Coca-Cola trades on the NYSE) can return an error or $0. Use the ticker symbol only.

Stock type	Correct format	Will cause problems	Real examples
Canadian stocks & ETFs (TSX)	Always add the TSE: prefix	RY alone can return the US (NYSE) listing, in USD	TSE:RY · TSE:VFV · TSE:ENB · TSE:XEQT
US stocks (NYSE / NASDAQ)	Ticker only, no prefix	NASDAQ:KO can return $0	KO · AAPL · JNJ · JPM · XOM · MCD
US ETFs	Ticker only, no prefix	NYSE:SPY can fail	SPY · VTI · QQQ · VIG · SCHD
US holdings in your RRSP	Ticker only, no prefix	NASDAQ:MSFT is unreliable	MSFT · GOOGL · V · MA · BRK.B

TSX-listed ETFs that hold US stocks (TSE:VFV, TSE:XSP) work with the TSE: prefix and save you converting to USD. Keep in mind that the 15% US withholding tax on their dividends applies inside the fund, even in an RRSP. Only US-listed ETFs (like VOO or VTI) held in an RRSP avoid it.